

Opinion of the Court

to say that the legal logic which critically determined *Richardson*'s outcome is beside the point here.

The FEC's strongest argument is its contention that this lawsuit involves only a "generalized grievance." (Indeed, if *Richardson* is relevant at all, it is because of its broad discussion of *this* matter, see *id.*, at 176–178, not its basic rationale.) The FEC points out that respondents' asserted harm (their failure to obtain information) is one which is "'shared in substantially equal measure by all or a large class of citizens.'" Brief for Petitioner 28 (quoting *Warth v. Seldin*, 422 U. S. 490, 499 (1975)). This Court, the FEC adds, has often said that "generalized grievance[s]" are not the kinds of harms that confer standing. Brief for Petitioner 28; see also *Lujan*, 504 U. S., at 573–574; *Allen v. Wright*, 468 U. S. 737, 755–756 (1984); *Valley Forge Christian College v. Americans United for Separation of Church and State, Inc.*, 454 U. S. 464, 475–479 (1982); *Richardson*, *supra*, at 176–178; *Frothingham v. Mellon*, decided with *Massachusetts v. Mellon*, 262 U. S. 447, 487 (1923); *Ex parte Levitt*, 302 U. S. 633, 634 (1937) (*per curiam*). Whether styled as a constitutional or prudential limit on standing, the Court has sometimes determined that where large numbers of Americans suffer alike, the political process, rather than the judicial process, may provide the more appropriate remedy for a widely shared grievance. *Warth*, *supra*, at 500; *Schlesinger v. Reservists Comm. to Stop the War*, 418 U. S. 208, 222 (1974); *Richardson*, 418 U. S., at 179; *id.*, at 188–189 (Powell, J., concurring); see also *Flast*, *supra*, at 131 (Harlan, J., dissenting).

The kind of judicial language to which the FEC points, however, invariably appears in cases where the harm at issue is not only widely shared, but is also of an abstract and indefinite nature—for example, harm to the "common concern for obedience to law." *L. Singer & Sons v. Union Pacific R. Co.*, 311 U. S. 295, 303 (1940); see also *Allen*, *supra*, at 754; *Schlesinger*, *supra*, at 217. Cf. *Lujan*, *supra*, at 572–578 (injury to interest in seeing that certain procedures are fol-